MCP

Title:
Tutoring Session

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TUTORING SESSION

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CHARACTERS:

EUNICE is smart and in love with Frank.

FRANK is a dumb football player.

- -

EUNICE sits at a table on her phone. FRANK walks in hurriedly.

FRANK
Sorry I'm late. Football went over.

EUNICE
I *told* you. I have something at 5.

Frank puts his hand on Eunice's. Eunice is visibly flustered.

FRANK
Please don't go. I need you.

EUNICE (O.S.)
He needs me.

EUNICE (CONT'D)
I guess I don't have to go to D&D this week. Although I spent hours writing my campaign..

FRANK
Ew, Eunice. I don't want to hear about your weird sex stuff.

EUNICE
Oh, no. It's-

FRANK
Plus, I've got to bring my grade up in this class. Otherwise, I'll have to retake English over the summer before college.

EUNICE
Alright, so what are we doing this week?

FRANK
Some Shakespeare story. I forgot what it’s called. Here are my notes.

Frank dumps out his book bag and shifts through multiple crumpled-up pieces of paper before he finds one.

FRANK (CONT'D)
I think this is it.

EUNICE
This is just a picture of a football.

FRANK
Oh yeah. I got distracted in class today, thinking about football.

EUNICE
Frank, you really have to start paying attention in class if you want to get into-

FRANK
Princeton, I know.

EUNICE
Wait, Princeton? Frank, I don’t think you have a chance of getting into Princeton. And I can say that because I am not going to get into Princeton. And I am your tutor.

FRANK
They said they’d give me a full ride if I could get my GPA up to a 2.0.

EUNICE
But..

FRANK
I know, I know. (Pause) I thought Harvard was more my speed. But they need me over there! They lost their quarterback because of some arson case that was totally rigged!

EUNICE
I don’t-

FRANK
Eunice! Focus! I've got a scholarship to earn here, and I'm paying you by the hour.

EUNICE
Alright.

Eunice opens Frank's textbook.

EUNICE (CONT'D) (CONT'D)
Ah, okay. Romeo and Juliet. I'll read for Juliet and you can read for Romeo.

FRANK
But I want to be the guy..

EUNICE
No, Juliet is.. okay. Fine. You read for Juliet.

FRANK
Thanks for understanding, Eunice. You know how it is. "Romeo, Romeo, wherefore art thou, Romeo? Deny thy father and refuse they name! And I shall no longer be a Catapult."

EUNICE
"Capulet."

FRANK
Eunice, it's not your line yet.

Frank gets a phone call.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Hey baby. No, no I'm not up to anything. Football practice was good, oh, yeah Carl's in the hospital again. Yeah, I tackled him a little too hard, what a little bitch. I fuckin told him if he didn't lean into the hits he'd end up back in the ICU and all the coaches agreed it's really his own damn fault at the end of the day. Okay yeah I'll see you at home. Bye mom. Oh, what's for dinner? Jesus Christ, again? I'm just gonna order pizza. Okay love you.

Frank kisses into the phone and hangs up.

EUNICE (O.S.)
He loves his mom...

EUNICE (CONT'D)
Okay. We should get back to work.

FRANK
Yeah, sure. Sorry.

Frank gets another notification on his phone.

FRANK (CONT'D)
Oh, shit! I just got my acceptance letter from Princeton! I guess they were just playing hard to get about the whole GPA thing. Okay, never mind Eunice. I guess none of this really matters anymore. I'll Venmo you for the hour, though.

Frank rises and grabs his book bag. He pauses.

FRANK (CONT'D) (CONT'D)
Also, I need to tell you something.

EUNICE (O.S.)
This could be it!

EUNICE (CONT'D)
Yeah.. me too.

FRANK
Oh! Okay. You go first.

EUNICE
Well.. we've been meeting up once a week since Freshman year of high school and in these four years I've really started to develop... well.. it's a bit embarrassing really-

FRANK
Wait, Eunice. Sorry to interrupt but you've had something in your teeth this whole time and I honestly have had no idea how to tell you it's so distracting.

Eunice looks into her phone and tries to get it out of her teeth.

EUNICE
Did I get it?

FRANK
Not really, no.

EUNICE
Anyways, what did you have to tell me?

FRANK
Oh, it was that. What I just told you. About the shit in your teeth. Anyways, as you were saying? Sorry.. could you hurry it up? My pizza is on the way.

EUNICE
Oh.. um.. I got into that school I was telling you about.

FRANK
Snead State Community?

EUNICE
You remembered!

FRANK
That’s great. I think community college will be a good pace for you. Anyways, I’ve gotta go. I guess this is it for us.

EUNICE
Yeah, but I mean I’ll see you in class and stuff.

FRANK
Well, sure. But it’s not like I’ll talk to you. My friends are there.

Frank starts to leave.

EUNICE
Congrats on Princeton! Go tigers!

FRANK
Don’t forget. The thing. In your mouth.

EUNICE
Oh. Right. Thanks.